

Founder CV

Mark Shea

Mount Vernon, Washington

Technologist • Educator • Community Systems Builder • Caregiving Advocate

Profile

My work has consistently centered around the intersection of people, systems, communication, and trust. Across careers in community supervision, caregiving, technical support, digital collaboration, education, and content systems, I have been drawn to a common question:

How do we create systems that help people coordinate, care for one another, and share knowledge without losing their dignity or autonomy in the process?

I am currently focused on the development of an open, privacy-preserving caregiving infrastructure designed to support aging in place through humane technology, community stewardship, and AI-assisted maintenance systems. My interest lies not simply in monitoring or automation, but in creating thoughtful systems that provide reassurance, reduce caregiver burden, and preserve independence without resorting to intrusive surveillance.

I believe that technology should support human care rather than replace it, and that open collaborative communities can build more adaptive, transparent, and compassionate systems than closed platforms alone.

Areas of Focus

- Aging-in-place support systems
- Humane and privacy-preserving technology
- Open-source community stewardship
- AI-assisted maintenance and support ecosystems
- Collaborative knowledge systems
- Technical communication and documentation
- Distributed learning communities

- Caregiver support infrastructure
 - Explainable and human-centered systems design
 - Local-first and transparent architecture
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Selected Experience

Home Care and Human Systems

Owner, Right at Home (Mount Vernon, WA)

2010–2011

Owned and operated an in-home care and assistance agency serving a four-county region in Washington State. The organization provided trained, insured, and bonded caregivers supporting a wide variety of home care needs.

This experience deepened my understanding of:

- caregiver realities and burnout
- aging-in-place challenges
- operational coordination in home care
- balancing safety with dignity and autonomy
- the emotional dimensions of caregiving infrastructure

The experience continues to strongly shape my philosophy regarding humane technology and supportive care systems.

Community Corrections Officer 3

Washington State Department of Corrections

1984–1997

Supervised adult offenders transitioning back into the community and worked closely with courts, treatment systems, employers, families, and community organizations.

Responsibilities included:

- community reintegration support

- counseling and referral coordination
- field supervision
- crisis management
- documentation and reporting
- balancing accountability with human dignity

This work required navigating complex human systems where trust, communication, judgment, and social context were often more important than rigid procedure alone.

Technology, Collaboration, and Knowledge Infrastructure

Microsoft

2001–2009

Served in multiple roles including:

- Product Manager
- Technical Writer
- Support Engineer
- Technical Lead
- Content Lead
- Trainer and Evangelist

My work focused primarily on enterprise collaboration systems, knowledge-sharing infrastructure, and technical content ecosystems surrounding Microsoft Project Server, SharePoint, and Microsoft Learning initiatives.

Areas of contribution included:

- collaborative publishing systems
- distributed content authoring communities
- technical communication for large-scale systems
- enterprise support infrastructure
- training and onboarding systems

- customer-driven documentation models

As Product Manager for the Microsoft Learning Courseware Library, I worked on systems that enabled distributed technical experts around the world to collaboratively author and publish learning content. This experience strongly influenced my later interest in open collaboration, digital commons, and community-maintained knowledge systems.

Attachmate

1997–2001

Served as:

- Escalation Engineer
- Training Program Manager
- Technical Support Analyst

Worked at the intersection of:

- customer advocacy
- enterprise systems
- technical training
- communication across organizational boundaries

The role required translating between technical teams, customers, support organizations, and leadership under high-pressure conditions. It reinforced the importance of clear communication, coordination, and trust in complex technical ecosystems.

Education and Communication

University of Washington

Master of Communication in Digital Media

2009

Graduate work focused on:

- digital collaboration
- participatory media

- online knowledge production
 - social systems in digital environments
 - communication theory in networked communities
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Visiting Lecturer

University of Washington
2010

Developed and taught a graduate-level course:

“Social Production and Distribution of Digital Content”

The course examined collaborative systems, digital publishing, and community-driven content ecosystems.

Instructor

Skagit Valley College
2013–2014

Taught Professional Communication with emphasis on:

- interpersonal communication
 - group dynamics
 - public speaking
 - leadership communication
 - workplace collaboration
 - conflict styles and listening
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Open Collaboration and Digital Commons

I maintain a longstanding interest in:

- Creative Commons
- open knowledge systems

- collaborative authorship
- participatory digital communities

I have contributed openly licensed work and participated in collaborative projects including Wikipedia, where I created and helped develop the article on the Skagit River.

My current interests explore how AI-assisted systems might help sustain healthy open-source communities by reducing maintenance burden, improving onboarding, supporting documentation, and preserving volunteer energy for creative and compassionate work.

Current Initiative

I am currently working toward the creation of an open, community-driven caregiving ecosystem focused on:

- privacy-preserving ambient sensing
- routine intelligence for aging in place
- explainable AI systems
- local-first architecture
- AI-assisted maintenance infrastructure
- humane technology design
- collaborative governance and stewardship

The long-term vision is to help create technological systems that support care without reducing human beings to surveillance targets or behavioral commodities.

Military Service

United States Marine Corps
Honorable Service, 1973–1975

Closing Note

I am particularly interested in collaborating with people who believe that:

- technology should preserve dignity

- communities can steward infrastructure together
- openness and transparency matter
- care systems should remain humane
- AI can reduce institutional burden without replacing human connection

The systems we build shape the relationships we live within. I believe foundations matter.